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Read less news

Good morning, Pro Briefers!

Selling data is nothing new - in fact, digital brands like Facebook have earned billions over the years by monetizing user data on its platform.

But the data monetization space is changing, which is where we've identified a Main Street Shift:

Businesses are reshaping the way they earn money through data marketplaces, alternative data, and data partnerships.

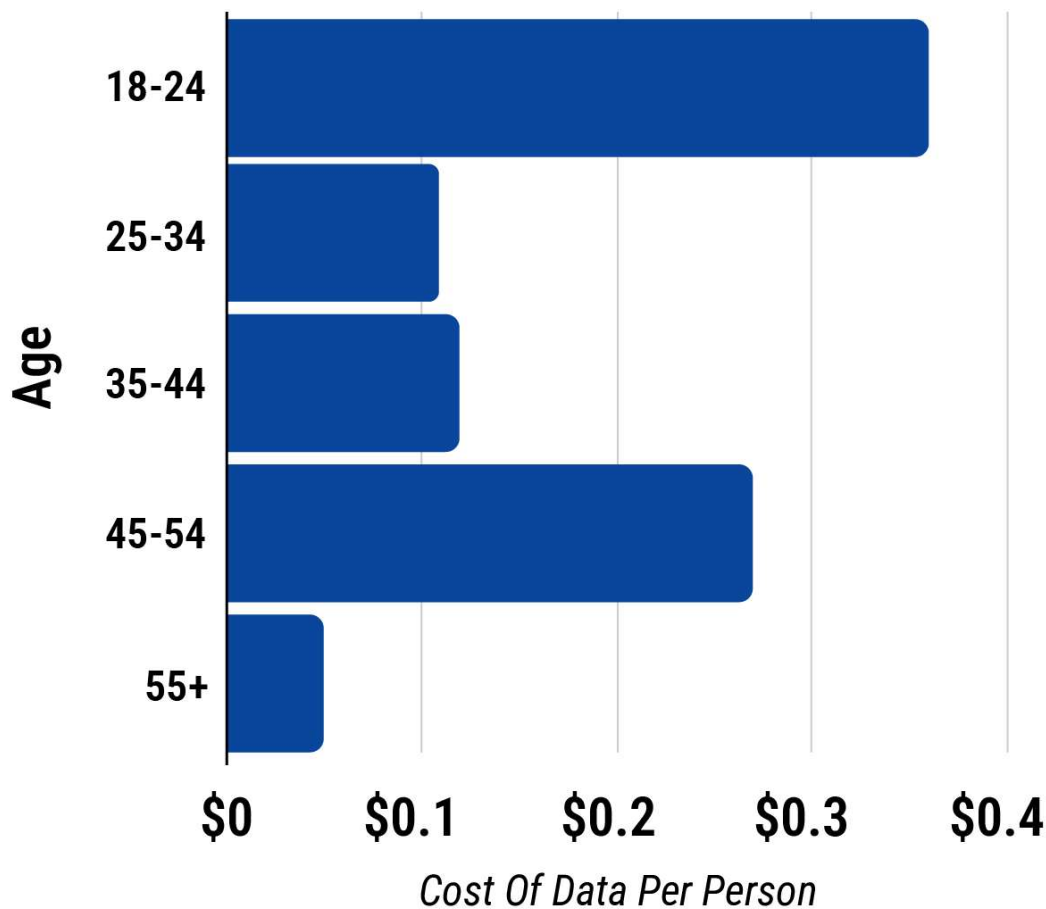
Let's break down this opportunity and how you may be able to benefit, starting with the basics of data monetization.

Meta (META), the parent company of Facebook, sells user data to advertisers.

- According to Tech Advisor, Facebook earns around \$900/user in 2025.

In 2023, it made \$133 billion in ad revenue by giving advertisers access to data from users on WhatsApp, Instagram, and Facebook.

How Much Businesses Spend On User Data



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Data [via](#) MacKeeper

But Meta isn't the only company earning money through selling data:

- Google earned \$224 billion by selling data in 2022.
- Disney (DIS) generated over \$7 billion by selling data in 2024.

Tech giants used to be the only players in the data monetization game - but data monetization is changing, allowing businesses of all sizes and in all industries to join in.

Why? AI.

As AI's like ChatGPT and Claude have grown, so has their need for data.

- In late April, 2025, Meta reported AI as a big factor in ad revenue increasing in Q1 of the same year.

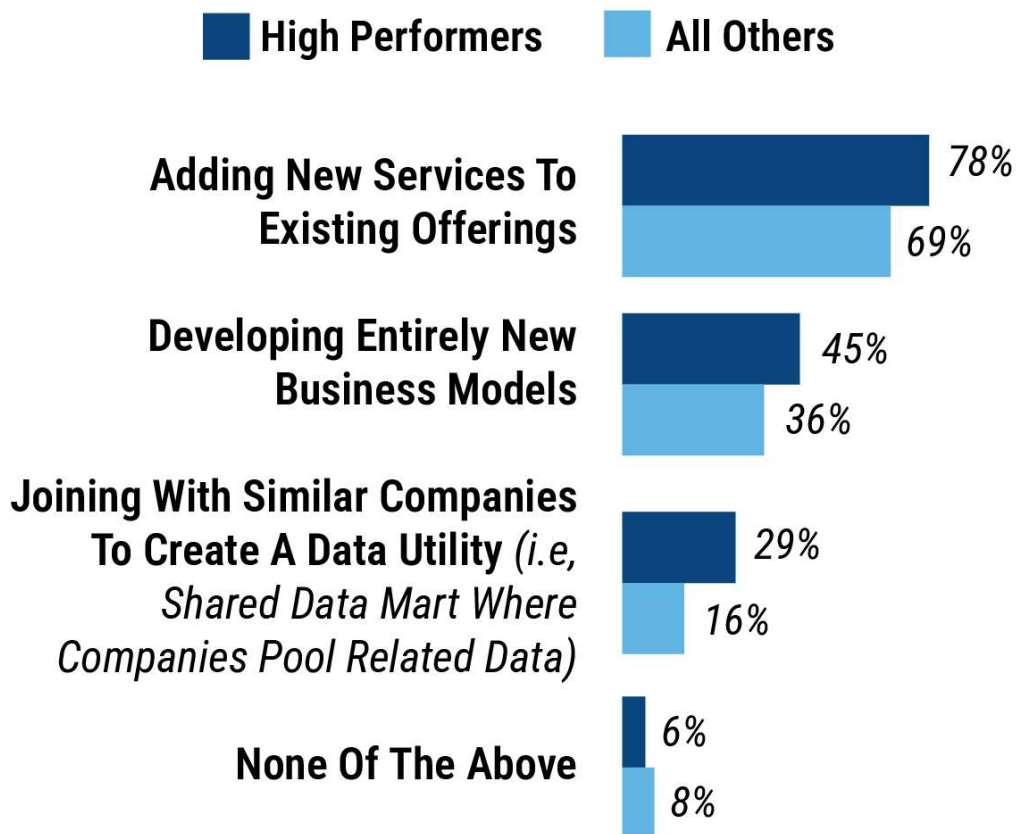
We spoke to Shalvi Singh, a Senior Project Manager of data monetization at Amazon AI, in an exclusive interview on how this space is changing today.

"In the last three to five years, we have seen a massive wave of change. The strategies have shifted simply from selling raw data to leveraging advanced analytics." - Shalvi Singh.

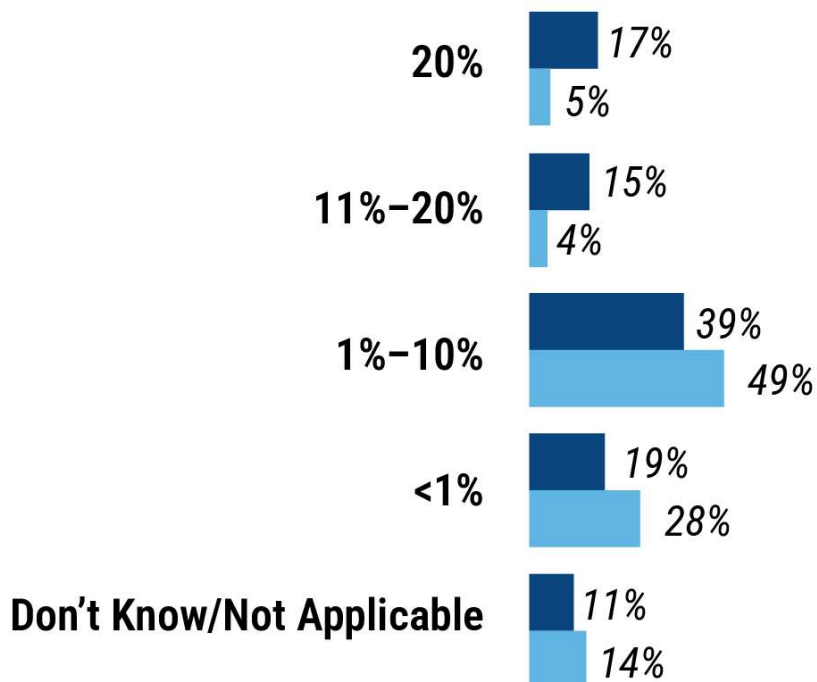
Around 42% of businesses are creating their own AI models - those models must be trained with real-time data.

The more data they have, the better they can be trained. So businesses are now searching for the most cutting edge and unique data sources in order to stay ahead of the competition.

Ways In Which Organizations Have Created New Businesses To Monetize Data



Contribution Of Data Monetization To Organizations' Total Revenues



The bottom line: Businesses aren't just selling data to advertisers anymore - businesses are selling data to one another, advertisers, and really anyone, as this unique info is key for creating the best AI.

This is creating new opportunities for many businesses to monetize their data in new ways - we'll break down each one of those opportunities next.

Have some feedback? Let us know your thoughts on this Shift by responding directly to this email!

DATA MARKETPLACES

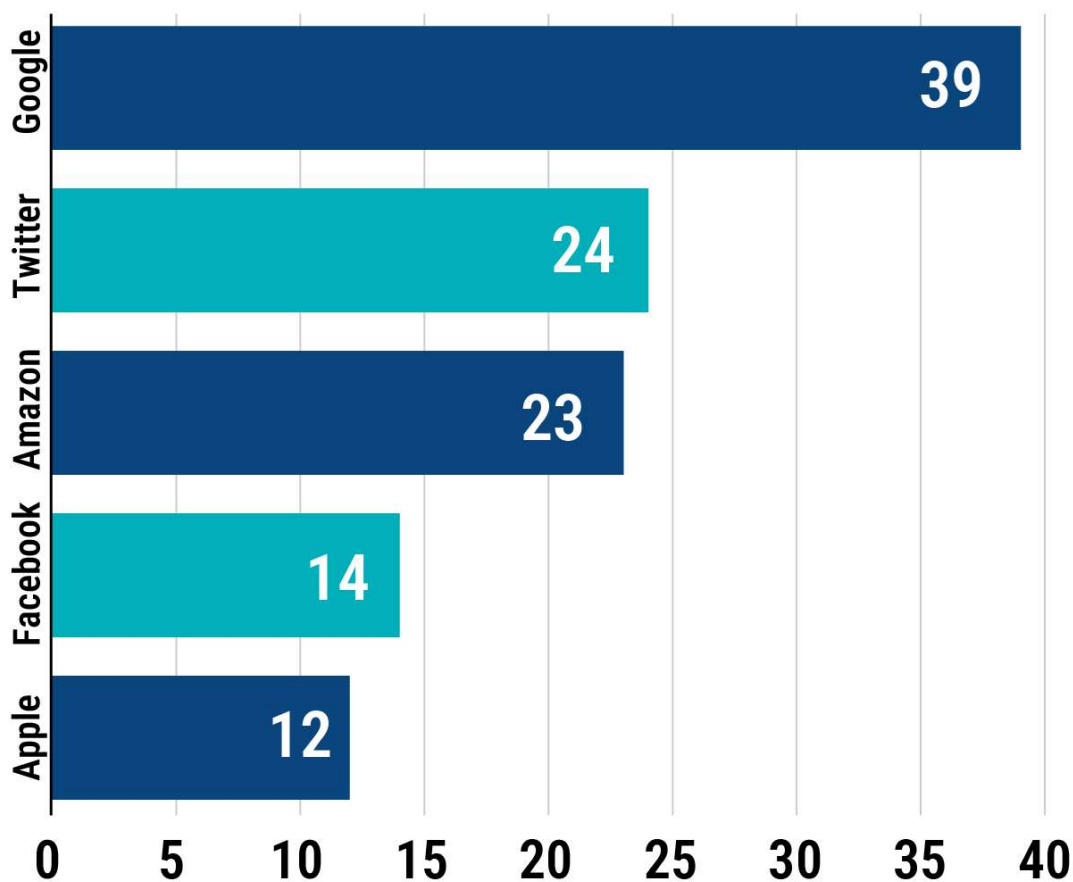
Where Data Is Bought And Sold

One of the most common ways businesses earn money from data is by selling it to a data marketplace where other businesses can buy it.

However, data marketplaces are kind of like a supermarket - there are thousands of pieces of data for sale, but you need to go to the right section in order to find it.

The problem: Businesses spend on average \$100,000 on packaged data on a data marketplace.

The Data Big Tech Companies Have On You



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Data via Digital Information World, as of 2023

They want to make sure the data they're buying can actually be used to train their AI model.

So, where's the opportunity? Companies need data to train their AI and they buy that data from online marketplaces.

But up until now, those marketplaces have been disorganized and hard to search, like a huge junk drawer.

So now, new marketplaces are popping up with data organized neatly so AI can use it for training.

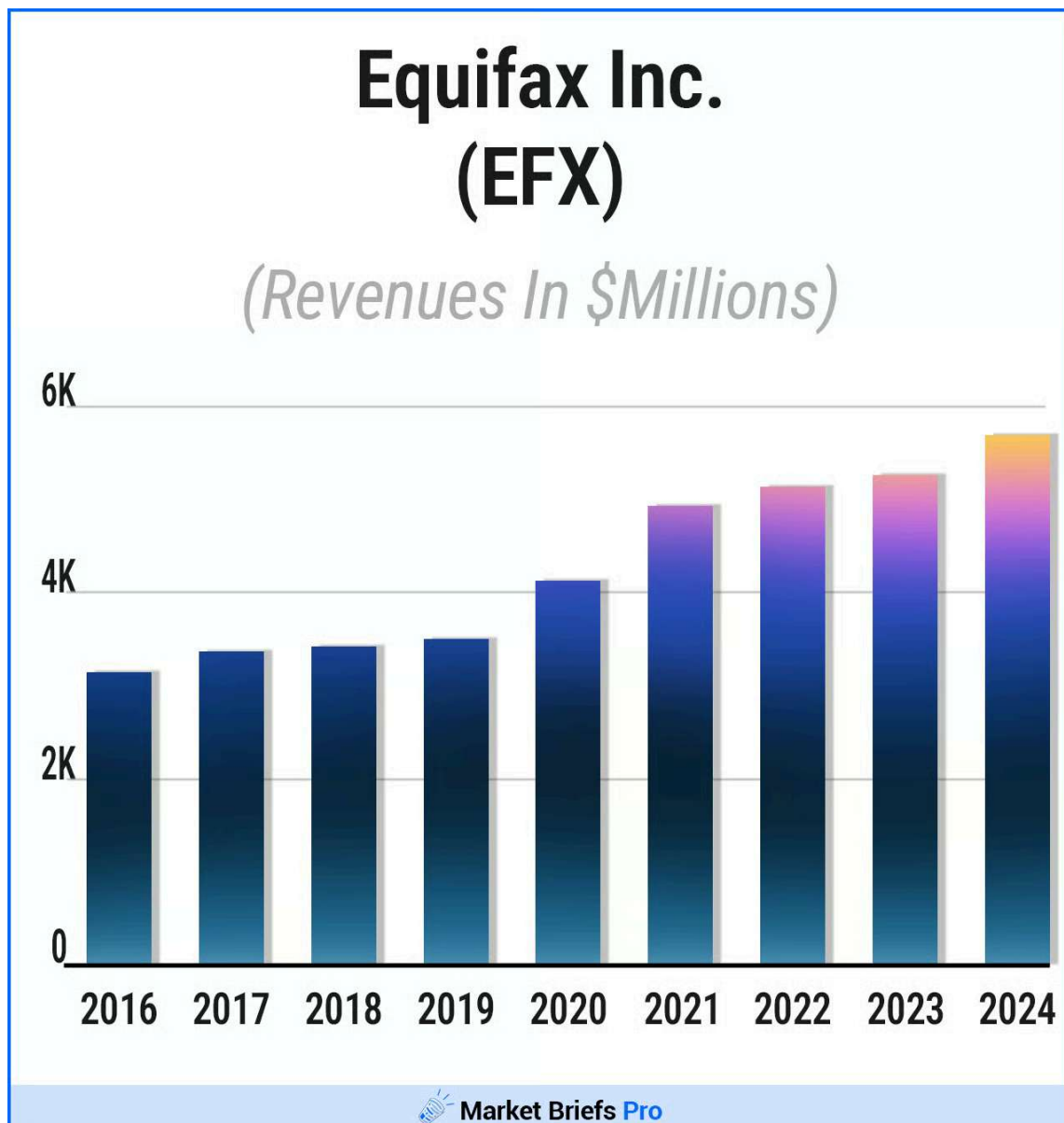
These are called "clean data marketplaces."

Shalvi Singh believes this is a growing opportunity for investors:

"The rise of data marketplaces and partnerships along with I'd say this massive explosion in data volume from internet of things is driving a

massive change and we are at the cusp of it."

Equifax (EFX) is one of the companies building those better, cleaner marketplaces.



Data [via](#) company reports

- It now packages and sells data to clean data marketplaces which contain consumer info like employment and wage history.

In fact, in Q1 of 2025, Equifax earned \$133 million from selling its clean customer data, a 7% year over year increase.

43% of the company's revenue in 2024 came from its Workforce Solutions segment, which focuses on curating data that can be sold to businesses.

Win-win. Equifax has slowly been introducing AI models to create credit scores since 2017. Those data sets are now being packaged and sold to clean data marketplaces.

Equifax Inc. (EFX)

217.72
(+67.43%)

5 Year Price →



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

- Overall, Equifax's revenue increased by 8% annually in 2024 to reach \$5.68 billion.

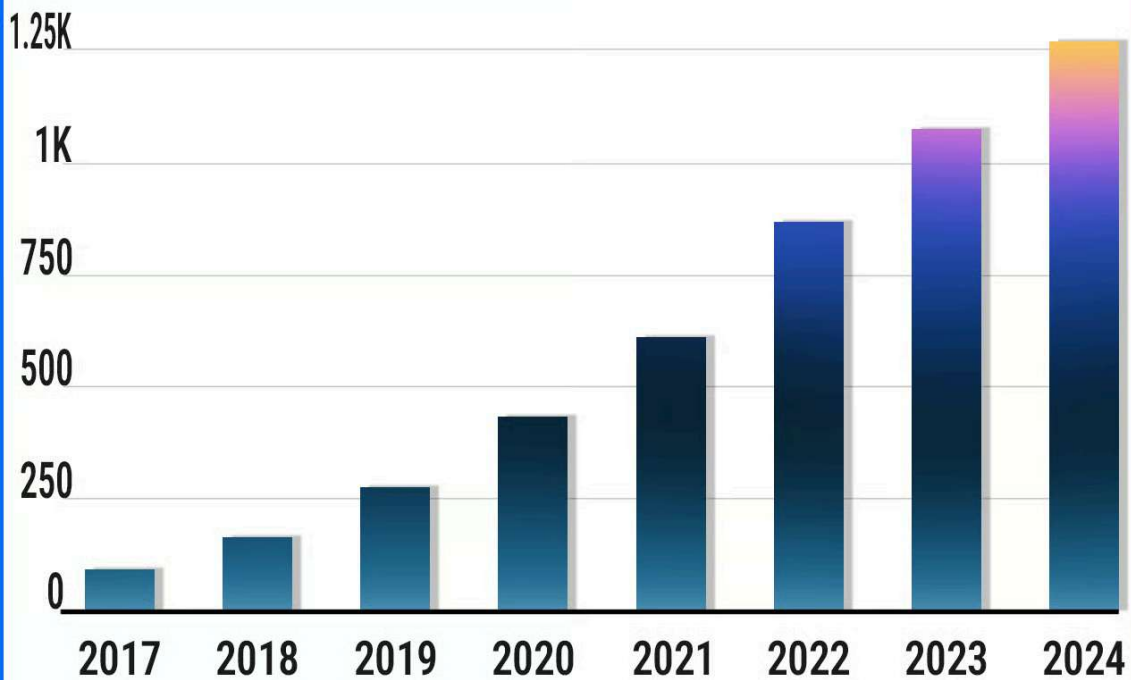
We've mentioned clean data marketplaces a few times - but which companies actually host marketplaces like that?

Elastic N.V. (ESTC) is a data analysis company that has created an innovative search engine for clean data.

What is it? Basically, its search engine helps companies find the best data to train AI, *by using AI*.

Elastic N.V. (ESTC)

(Revenues In \$Millions)



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Data [via](#) company reports

- It also synthesizes lots of data fast, which saves time for businesses searching for data.

Elastic earns money from business customers who subscribe to its AI data searching platform, and the company has 1,330 subscribers with contract values exceeding \$100,000 or more.

- That's up from 1,160 subscribers in 2023.

As a result, Elastic increased its annual revenue in 2024 by 19% to \$1.26 billion.

Elastic N.V. (ESTC)

75.21
(+28.43%)

5 Year Price →



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

And as demand for clean data marketplaces grows, so will demand for Elastic's AI-driven data search engine.

Clean data marketplaces are a broad and emerging space in tech and other opportunities for investors also include the Global X Data Center & Digital Infrastructure ETF (DTCR).

Global X Data Center & Digital Infrastructure ETF (DTCR)

15.35
(+4.71%)

5 Year Price →



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

ALTERNATIVE DATA

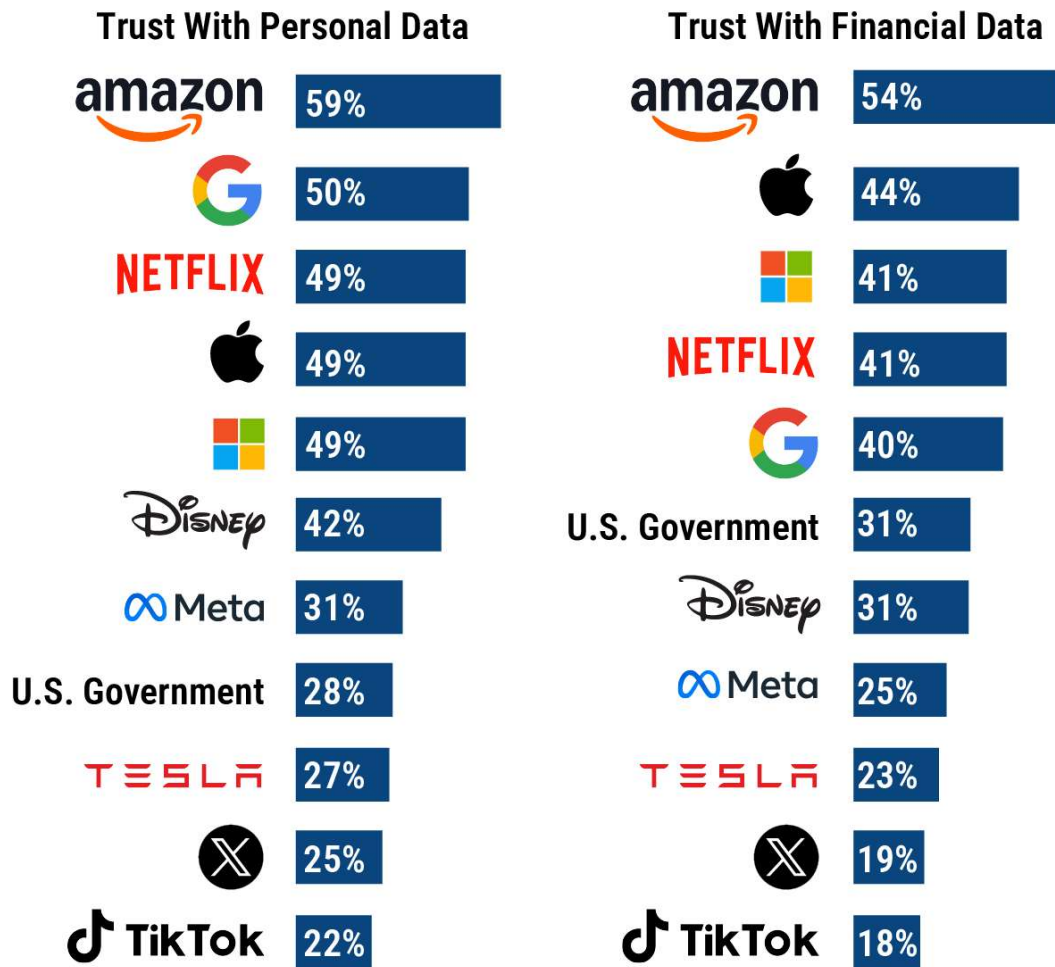
New Sources Of Data

Fact. AI models like ChatGPT search the open web for the most up-to-date data.

But publicly available info is getting harder to come by.

What's going on? Exploding Topics found last year that 61% of people don't want any of their data being collected by a business.

Do You Trust Tech Companies With Your Data?



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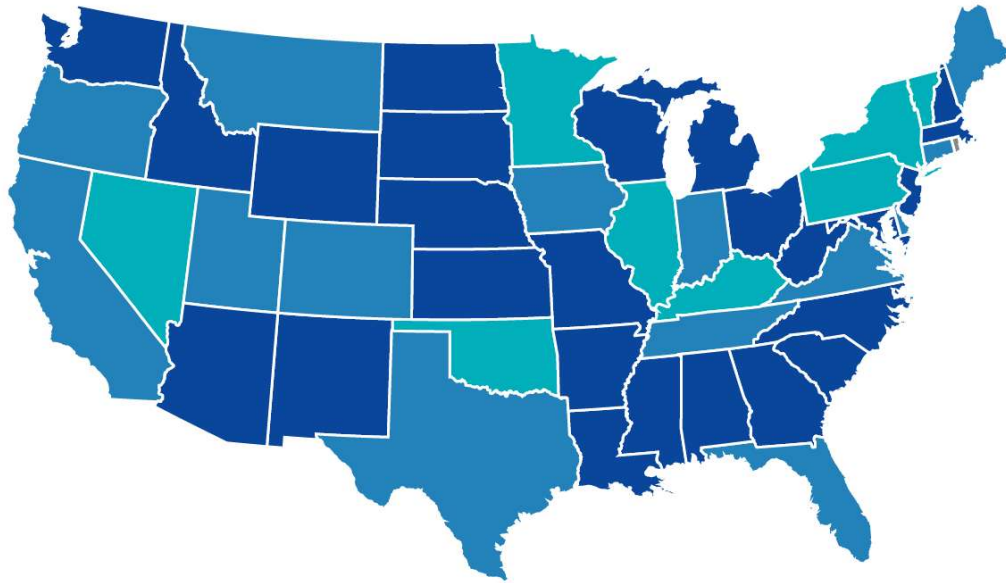
Data [via](#) All About Cookies

This has led to regulations on what data businesses are able to collect, and how they track and sell it.

For instance, California passed a law back in 2018 limiting how businesses track and sell data in the state.

- The E.U. passed similar user data protection laws that same year.

U.S. Data Privacy Laws By State



- States Currently Considering PII Privacy Laws As Of 12 January 2024**
- States With Signed PII Privacy Laws In Effect Or Scheduled To Go Into Effect**
- States Where No Comprehensive Bills Have Been Introduced As Of 12 Jan 2024**



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Data [via](#) Congress

Businesses need this data so that it can be used to train AI engines like ChatGPT.

There's a bigger issue with public data - any business can find and use it, so no business has a competitive advantage, even if more of it was available.

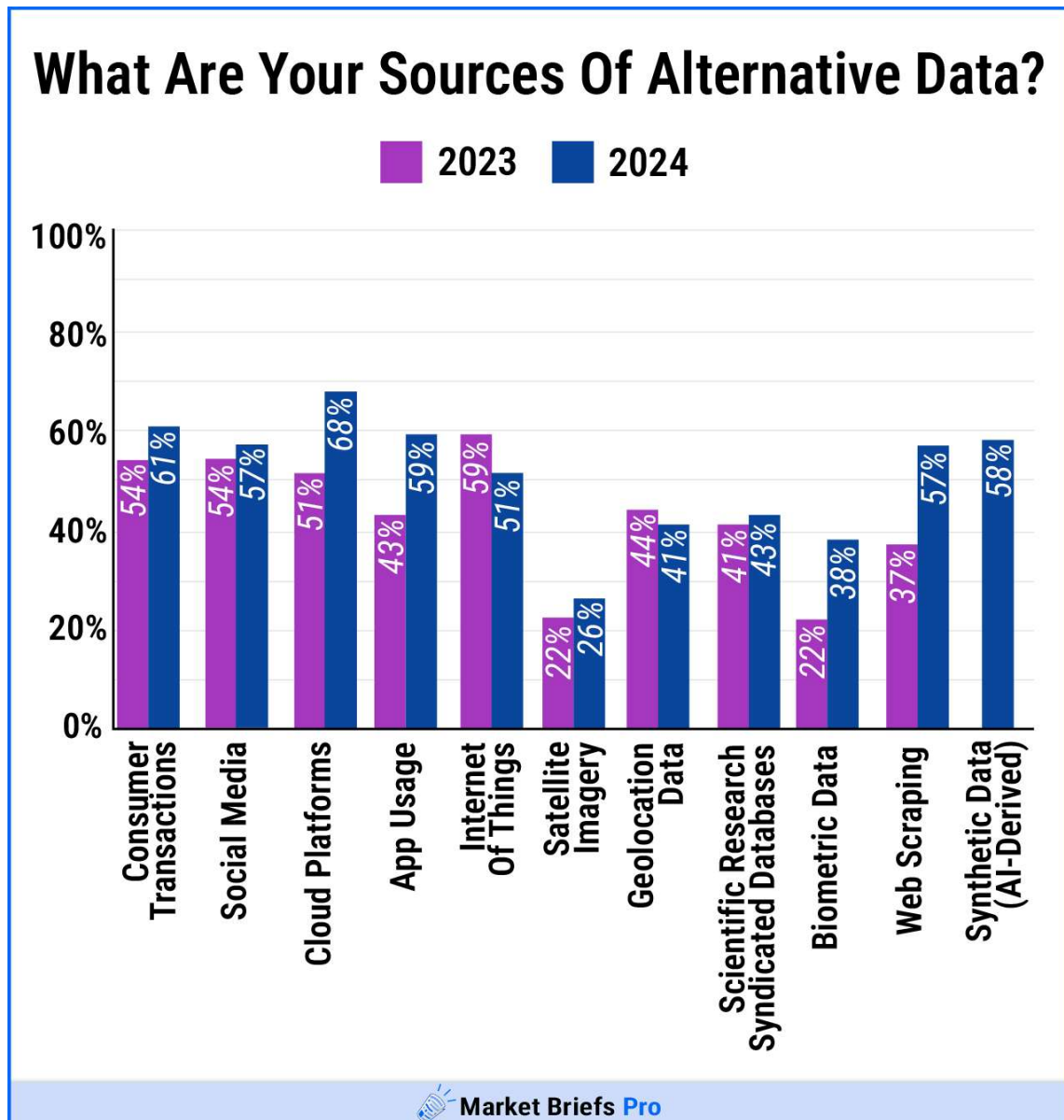
How are businesses getting ahead? *With alternative data.*

Alternative data goes beyond cell phone numbers and email addresses - its focus is on extremely niche and unique consumer info.

- For example - alternative data could track how many times you stop to get coffee or grab breakfast on your daily commute into the city.

According to Datnami, more than 62% of businesses used alternative data in 2024, up from 32% in 2023.

"Alternative data is the big thing. Every movement, every recorder, every app, and everything that is a non-variable that has some sort of sensing - it's all forming a massive pool of data which is hugely part of the monetization industry." - Shalvi Singh.



Data via Big Data Wire

The point? These datasets are very unique, and cannot be found anywhere else online, which helps businesses create highly personalized products and customize ad campaigns.

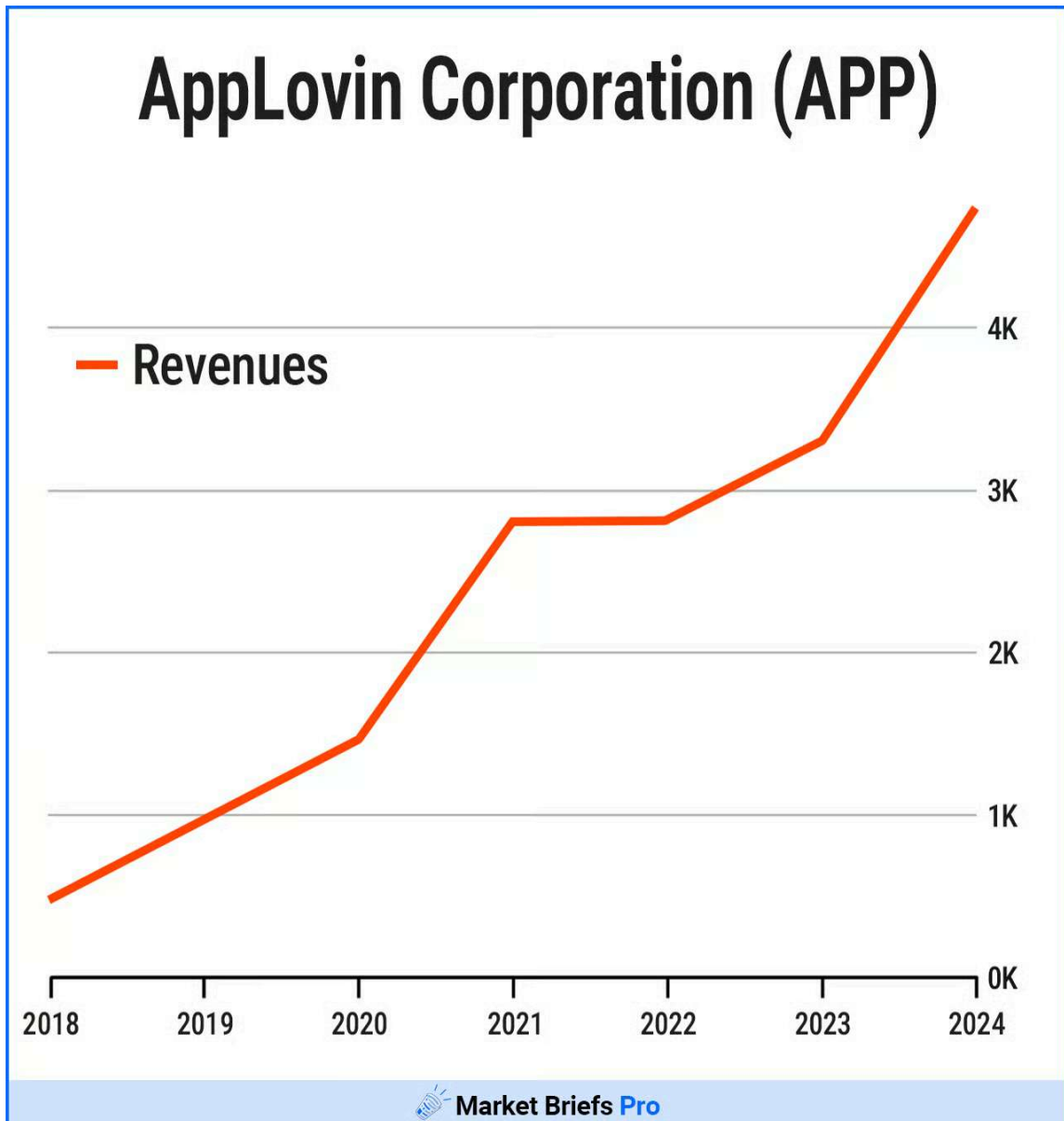
Applovin (APP), a software platform for app developers, has significantly expanded the alternative data it provides to customers in recent years.

The company helps businesses get more customers through its software.

- Applovin hosts the ads for businesses, so it also has access to all of the data for the ads.

It now tracks things like customer behavior, popular platforms, customer journeys on a site, and much more. Then, it packages and sells it to data

marketplaces.



Data [via](#) company reports

Applovin also bought Wurl in 2022, which hosts streaming and cable TV services for content companies.

The company now has access to cable and streaming viewership patterns, as well as any consumer behavior around the shows they watch the most or don't watch at all.

In 2024, its advertising segment grew by 75% year over year to reach \$3.22 billion.

AppLovin Corporation (APP)

4 Year Price →

225.74
(+222.49%)



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

While Applovin collects data based on the ads on its platforms, there are also companies who have made it their business just collecting data.

Verisk Analytics (VRSK) is one of those companies that has expanded into alternative data in recent years.

How? Verisk primarily focuses on collecting data in the financial industry and collects info like:

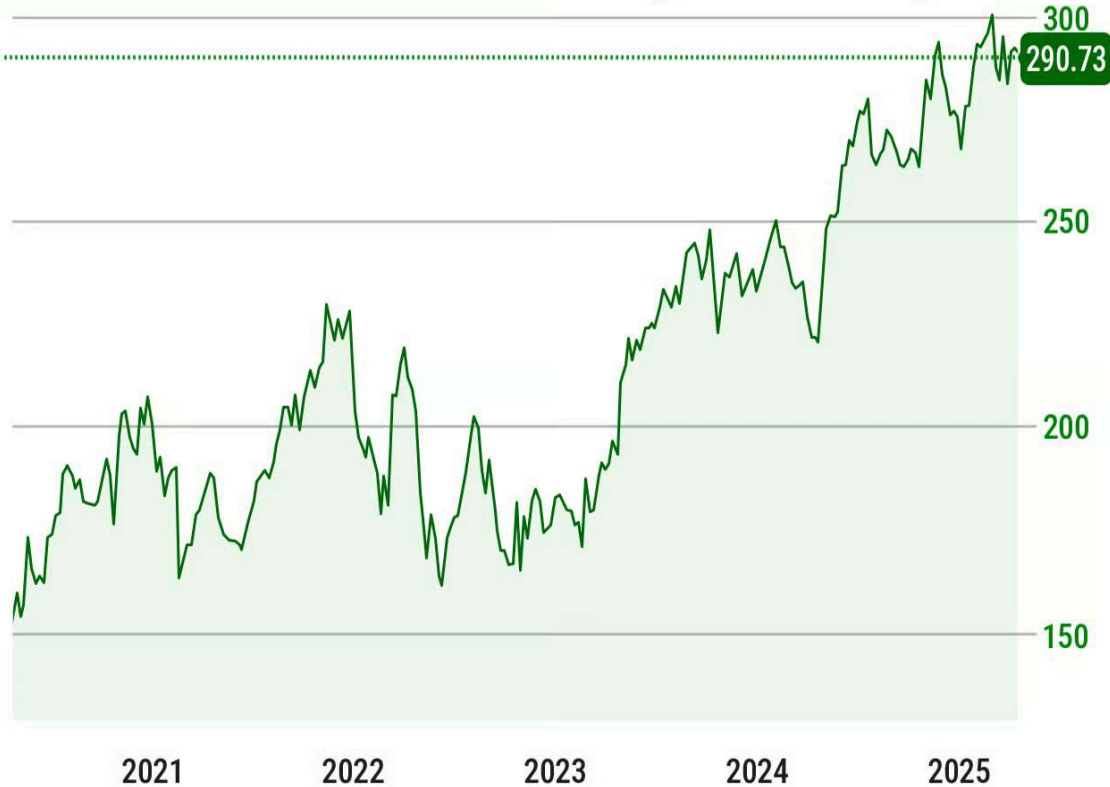
- Monthly cashflow on rental properties
- Rent prices
- Utility prices
- Credit scores
- Insurance claims

And much more.

Verisk Analytics, Inc. (VRSK)

5 Year Price →

290.73
(+100.21%)



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

It then sells this data to insurance companies - its insurance customers increased their revenues by almost 7% in Q4 of 2024 with the help of Verisk's alternative data.

As a result, Verisk reported \$2.88 billion in annual revenue in 2024, a 7% increase annually.

The alternative data market is expected to become a \$635 billion industry by 2034, up from \$15 billion in 2025.

Xtrackers Artificial Intelligence And Big Data ETF (XAIX)

1 Year Price →

29
(+2.20%)



 Market Briefs Pro

Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

That means both Verisk and Applovin are poised to benefit from this shift, as well as other broad opportunities in the space, which can be found in an ETF like the Xtrackers Artificial Intelligence and Big Data ETF (XAIX).

DATA PARTERSHIPS

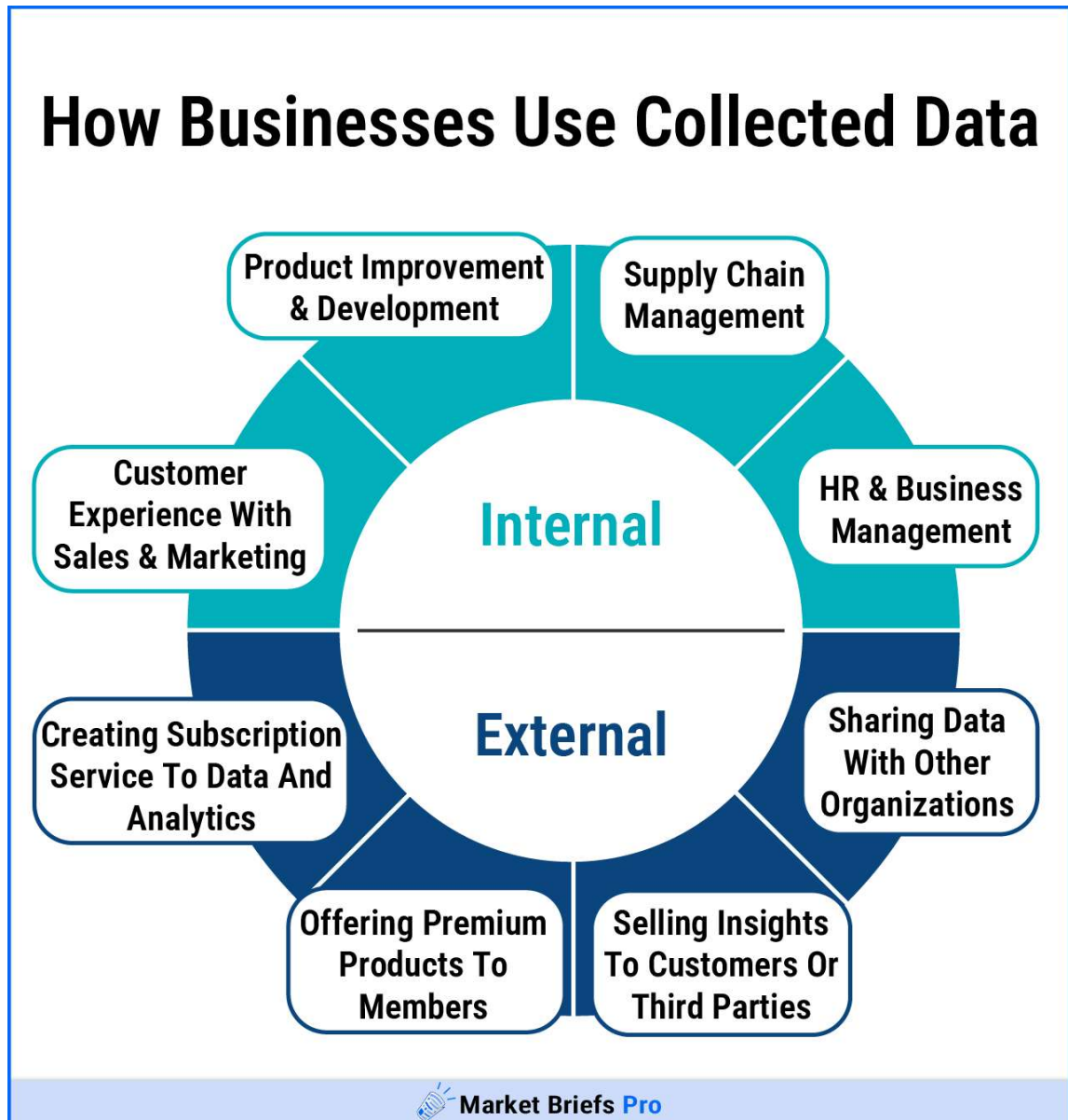
Big-Data Team-Ups

Businesses that can't buy the data they need on a marketplace are starting to go right to the source.

What does that mean? Businesses can partner with other brands to gain exclusive access to their data.

"Data partnerships with data marketplaces are gaining massive traction. It's also enabling companies to monetize data collaboratively or either through external platforms or through some internal media." - Shalvi Singh.

For example, Uber (UBER) and Mastercard (MA) entered a data partnership last year.

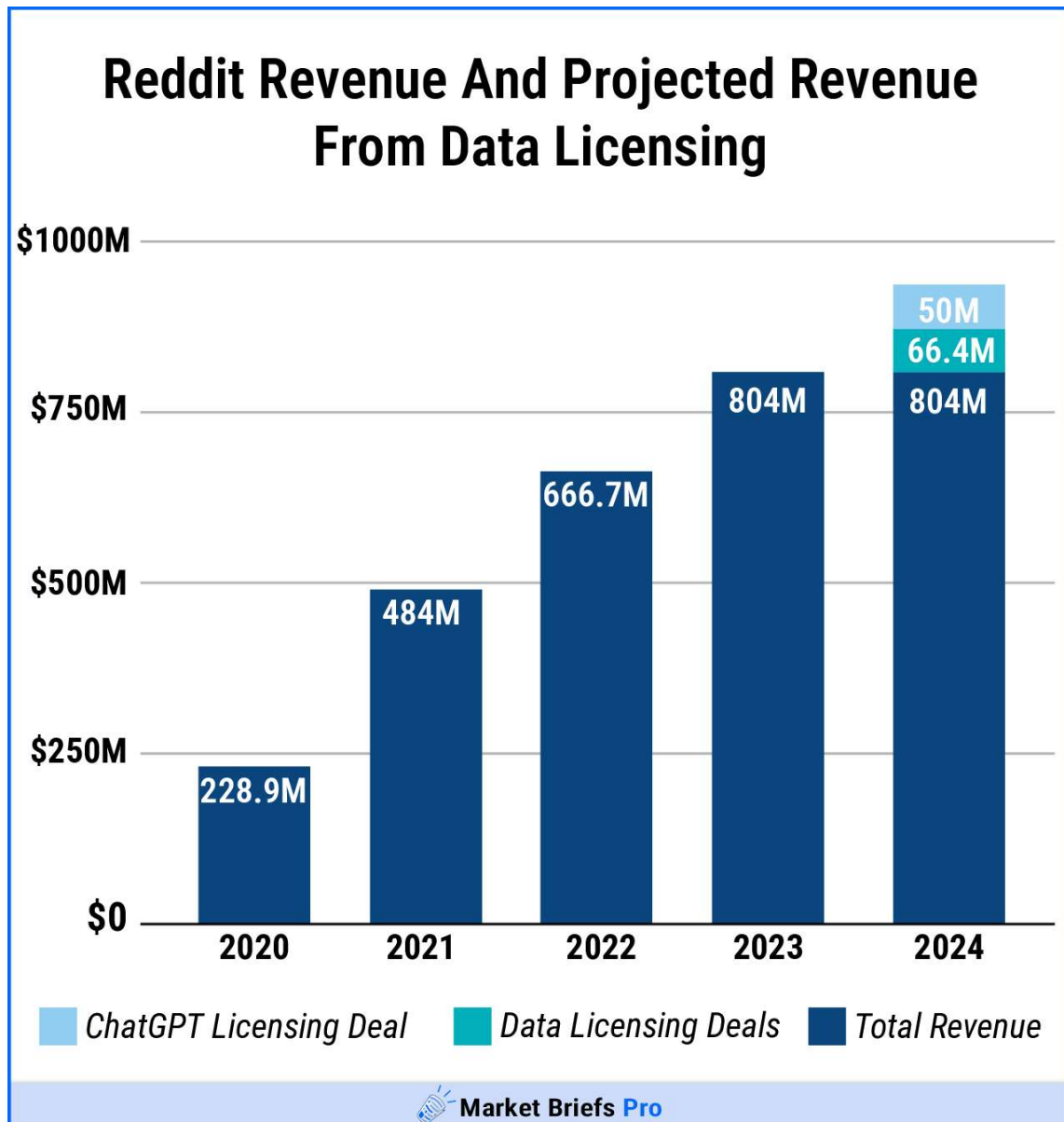


Data [via](#) Payments Journal

- Uber provides the most popular places people like to get picked up and dropped off so that Mastercard can place banks and ATMs near those locations.
- Mastercard provides Uber customers with a discount they can use if the rider pays with a Mastercard.

But that's not all...Reddit (RDDT), the social media platform, has recently started monetizing its data through partnerships.

It's now even working with some of the biggest names in tech like Google and Open AI, the maker of ChatGPT.



Data [via](#) Small Cap Steve

How does it work? AI companies need data to train their AI's - Reddit collects this user data from its platform and sells it to its partners.

- Reddit's multi-year deal with Google struck in 2024 will earn it \$60 million per year.

It will also earn \$70 million from OpenAI, just to provide the platform exclusive data for feeding ChatGPT.

Reddit's ad revenue has exploded as well - it reported \$1.3 billion in ad revenue annually in 2024, a 61% increase year over year, mainly from its data partnerships.

Reddit, Inc. (RDDT)

1 Year Price →

92.31
(+125.84%)



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

SAP (SAP) has also increased its overall revenue from data partnerships over the past year.

It does so through licensing agreements with big names like Amazon (AMZN), Hyundai, Microsoft (MSFT), and more.

SAP is a data management company at heart - meaning it handles data remotely online for businesses.

SAP SE (SAP)

5 Year Price →

248.81
(+103.01%)



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

It then generates additional data for the brands it partners with and provides detailed analytics.

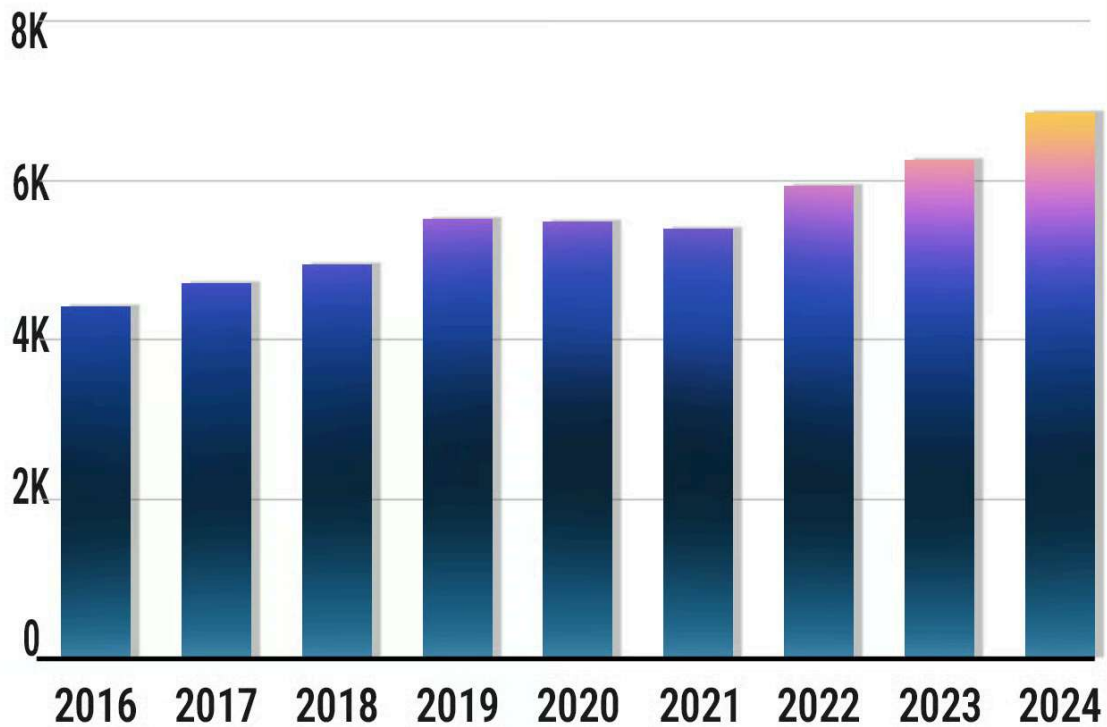
In English: SAP manages a company's current data stream, but then also works to discover new data points, selling that exclusive info back to the company.

- Last year, the company earned \$34 billion in yearly revenue, up from \$31 billion in 2023.

These new data points found by SAP are unique and exclusive and more than 25,000 enterprises around the world now have data partnerships with SAP.

SAP SE (SAP)

(Revenues In \$Millions)



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Data *via* company reports

RISKS

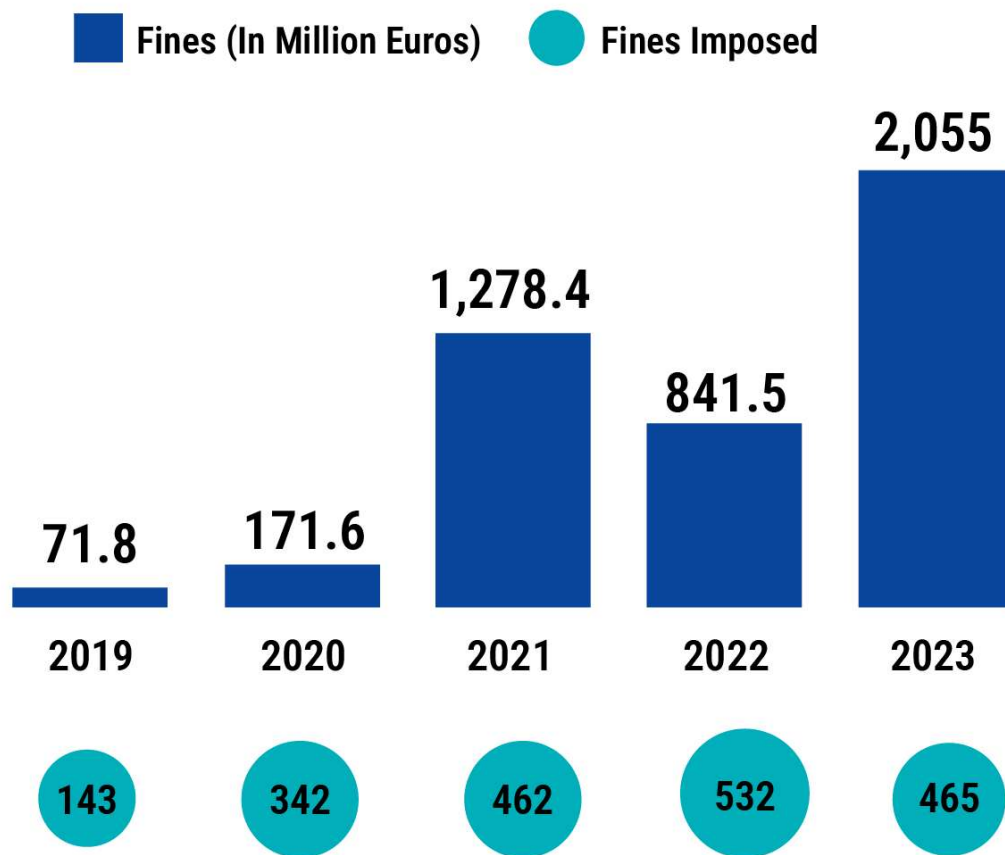
The Dangers Of Data

Opportunities in data monetization are growing - but investors may want to keep an eye on these risks.

First, global regulations are always changing around data collection and some companies have paid high fines for breaking these regulations.

EU Data Protection Fines Hit Record High In 2023

Fines Imposed In The EU As A Result Of General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) Violations



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Data [via](#) European Data Protection Board

- Meta was fined \$1.3 billion in the E.U for breaking data privacy laws - the biggest on record.
- Equifax was fined \$700 million for one of the largest data breaches in history back in 2017.

"I haven't seen a full-fledged solution of end risks that have been at least put under purview [of GDPR or CCPA] when AI is being treated." - Shalvi Singh.

Second, consumers are increasingly less likely to allow businesses to track their data - this may make the monetization of data a difficult long term strategy.

Lastly, whether data is “good” or not is completely dependent on the business that is using it.

No one knows how valuable clean data marketplaces or alternative data packages will be just yet, so any investments into them could one day be worthless.

REVIEW

Follow The Data

Making money from just selling data on the open market is so 2000 and late.

Businesses are now leveraging alternative data, new clean data marketplaces, and data partnerships to monetize unique data.

That means this opportunity stretches beyond just tech or social media companies - any company can now collect unique data and sell it to other businesses.

And while data privacy laws have created some setbacks in the industry, one thing is clear: Businesses need data to get ahead and grow their business.

Many are now shifting their spending in order to get it in creative ways, something investors will want to keep an eye on as this shift develops.

"I think the health tech industry is going to gain a massive advantage with AI and data monetization put together. And I would really watch out on some of the wearable based health tech industries around twin digital health creation as well." - Shalvi Singh.



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